

Teaching Statement

To teach coordination problems, I leveraged recent work from Bursztyn and colleagues.¹ I asked students on Menti how much they would have liked to be paid (or pay) to get off social media, either individually or while everyone else quits at the same time. Most of them requested money to abandon social media alone, yet offered money for everyone to leave them simultaneously. This replicated the core finding of the paper. I provocatively asked the students: “So, what are we doing, still on social media?” Turns out, we were all in a coordination trap.

In many similar cases, influential scholarly work with important implications stems from a simple idea. This observation animates my pedagogical approach. I structure my teaching around an idea, and I guide the students to have the intuition themselves. I then restate the idea clearly and move on to its implications. This movement aptly joins theoretical concepts and empirical evidence: once the real-world implications of the abstract argument are clear, we are ready to consider quantitative or qualitative cases for or against it. Often, evidence clarifies the mechanisms or the scope conditions underpinning arguments. This allows us to close the lecture in a circular motion: we get back to the core idea, solidifying it to make sure it is readily usable in seminars and autonomous work. This teaching style ensures knowledge is approachable without sacrificing rigour. It is also flexible, as it can be applied to more than one concept in a session.

Relying on student participation is a bet that has paid off: my experience has taught me how to make complexity digestible and ensure students are always the protagonists of their learning. This has been rewarded by generous evaluations, never dipping below 4.5 points out of 5 when collected.

As a Teaching Assistant at LSE, I taught 160+ contact hours across various political science courses, including public policy, and delivered countless hours of individual support and dissertation supervision. I also offered extensive feedback on various formative exercises and graded summative essays. Throughout this time, I had the chance to develop a confident and warm presence in the classroom. Most importantly, I learned how to keep communication channels open for feedback of any sort, making sure the students are comfortable sharing their uncertainties about the material or the teaching, either live, by email, or during office hours.

Last year, I had the enriching experience of teaching Politics of Public Policy to graduate students at UCL, joining the Department of Political Science as an Associate Lecturer. I learned a great deal from colleagues, particularly through discussions on syllabus edits and grading criteria across departments, as the MSc in Data Science and Public Policy was jointly delivered by the Department of Economics. The students reflected the interdisciplinarity of the degree, with backgrounds ranging from Sociology to Computer Science, and many new to the British higher education system. I strived to infuse a sense of clarity: I presented them with a clear course timeline, returning to it each week to highlight upcoming tasks and deadlines, and weaving the day’s subject into the broader story of the course. I detailed and explained in depth the evaluation criteria for final assessments. I closed on a crowdsourced revision lecture, based on the needs expressed in a dedicated survey. I believe, based on impression and feedback, that most students felt a sense of direction and agency throughout the course.

I am committed to further improving my skills. I believe that continuous learning is essential to teaching, and I intend to enrol in professional certification programs, such as a Fellowship with the Professional Standards Framework, to further my understanding of how to best transmit complex ideas.

¹ Bursztyn, L., Handel, B. R., Jimenez, R., & Roth, C. (2023). *When Product Markets Become Collective Traps: The Case of Social Media*. NBER. <https://doi.org/10.3386/w31771>